

Tobias Treppmann

Product Designer (Senior/Staff) who prototypes in real code and builds the systems that keep a growing product from diverging

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PROFILE

I prototype in real code against production APIs, and the external engineering agency ships from that code. The design system is mine: four token tiers built to serve iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source, so the standard holds without a designer reviewing every change. Alongside, a decade mentoring and coaching designers. This seat is IC by choice, not a step back from the Head-of roles before it.

My prototypes ship

an external engineering agency builds from my code

4 tiers

token architecture built to reconcile divergence before it happens

10 years

mentoring and coaching designers, in parallel with every role

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- I prototype in real code against production APIs, web first then Android. The engineering agency ships from that code, so the handoff crosses a company boundary and holds.
- A four-tier token architecture built to reconcile divergence before it happens. Primitives, semantic, component, page/view. The upper tiers alias downward, so one change propagates to every consuming platform.
- Storybook is the source of truth, and the build enforces it. Checks run locally and in CI and refuse a token that does not resolve or a hardcoded value.
- No in-house design team, so I own UI quality across four platforms. Product managers shape features; I am building the path that lets them prototype with Claude against real Storybook components.
- Product manager and product owner for the redesign, alongside design. I write and prioritize the tickets engineering works from, and check features in beta and production.
- Introduced agentic-engineering prototyping as a practice across the team.
- A support copilot in production for viewer services. It drafts in the handbook's wording, and every send decision stays human.
- A color engine and the tool that tunes it, both live. K-means in OKLCH, with WCAG contrast held in light and dark.

Senior Mentor

2016 – 2026

CareerFoundry (online school for UX and UI design) Remote · in parallel with the roles below

- A decade mentoring and coaching designers through career transitions.
- Portfolio guidance, personalized feedback and coaching, and constructive critique of student work until it was industry-ready.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Product management for the main platform alongside all product design. Roadmap, specs, the engineering ticket board, and the main contact for the launch customer.
- Built booking into the platform instead of bolting on a module. Extending the existing calendar and form builder let one build carry funerals, room rentals, baptisms and weddings.
- 70% less coordination time and 90% booking acceptance at the launch customer. Then rolled out to the whole customer base.
- Delivered in two months, on a fixed budget, with two engineers.
- Customers met the European Accessibility Act automatically on the websites the platform hosts for them, across six countries.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Wrote the levelling framework for design and UX writing and made two promotions against it. Designed and ran a lean 360-degree review as a workshop format.
- Owned the design system and established joint governance with engineering.
- Five direct reports, on the Senior Leadership Team. For four months also interim Head of Product: nine people across two functions.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization. Case-by-case support became standardized, scalable service offerings.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense B2B interfaces for analysts inside banks and insurers. Pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, filter logic.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC, two UX designers reporting to me, as a functional head among functional heads.
- Defined component behavior and specs across the co-built design system.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Design Consultant · *Ninox Software GmbH* · Summer 2025 · freelance · prompt-to-database AI onboarding, basis for the public AI beta

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Earlier · *Web Designer, Freelance Web Designer, E-Commerce Assistant* · 1999 – 2009 · Düsseldorf and Hagen, Germany

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

Completed 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

AI-Enabled Design Workflow

Hand-coded and AI-assisted prototypes in real code against production APIs, web first then Android · Claude Code, Claude Projects and Claude skills daily · Kotlin and Jetpack Compose for the Android prototype · HTML, CSS and some JavaScript by hand, agentic engineering for the rest · Figma with auto layout for concept, layout and flow · A support copilot and an AI fundraising ecosystem in production

Reusable Frameworks and Abstractions

DTCG tokens in four tiers (primitives, semantic, component, page/view), built with Style Dictionary to serve iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source · Storybook as the source of truth · Checks identical locally and in CI · Design-system ownership with joint governance established with engineering at Ninox · Component specs, token naming and redlines as the handoff standard at ChurchDesk

Product Direction and Ownership

Product manager and product owner for the Bibel TV redesign, with the autonomy and accountability that come with owning the product area · Product management for ChurchDesk’s main platform · Roadmap, specs and the engineering ticket board · Clarity in ambiguity: reframed the ChurchDesk brief from a funeral-booking feature into a platform capability · Design strategy that balances ambitious goals with practical constraints: the general booking capability delivered inside a two-month, fixed-budget window · Final design-side sign-off over UI and solution work with an external agency

Mentoring and Feedback

A decade mentoring and coaching designers at CareerFoundry · Levelling framework for design and UX writing at Ninox, with two promotions made against it · Performance reviews and a lean 360-degree workshop format · Coached a design lead through a difficult engineering relationship

Elevating Craft

Initiatives I identified and drove to raise quality across the product area at Bibel TV: the design system as an API, the color engine and the Storybook rails · Color engine in OKLCH with WCAG contrast validated in light and dark · Adaptive layouts across phone, tablet, desktop web and connected TV · Inclusive by default: screen-reader semantics and ARIA · Data-dense interfaces for analysts inside banks and insurers · Multi-step gradients that hold on old displays

Research

Interviews transcribed in Teams and analyzed with Claude · Dovetail as the research repository · Thousands of forum posts analyzed with Claude for sentiment and recurring pain points · Iterative usertesting.com screening for hard-to-reach analysts · New features tested against the existing version